

Philipp Hilbert. *AI-literate Proxy Product Owner, translating ambiguity into delivery.*

Positioning, 13 years turning unstructured AI and data ambitions into prioritised, implementation-ready backlogs, across regulated industries and cross-functional teams.

BERLIN, GERMANY · HILBERT@TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN · TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · www.true-north.berlin · [YouTube \(EN sample\)](#)

§ WHY REPLY DEUTSCHLAND SE

Reply is engaged at a major automotive OEM to drive AI use-case discovery and governance, exactly the kind of programme where the gap between business ambition and engineering reality is widest and most expensive. The posting calls out the full lifecycle from ideation through speedboat delivery to industrialisation planning, which maps precisely to the work I did at Rohde & Schwarz on the FCAS AI platform and at the Bundesagentur für Arbeit on its national analytics platform. Working through a structured consultancy that bridges the Tier-1 automotive world and AI delivery is a context where rigour and pragmatism have to coexist. *That is exactly the environment where careful scoping and ruthless prioritisation compound.*

§ HONEST FRAMING

I have not worked directly inside an automotive OEM or on warranty, aftersales, or commercial vehicle systems. The transferable mechanic is strong: I have spent the last three years owning AI and data platform backlogs in other regulated, engineering-heavy environments, defence (Rohde & Schwarz / FCAS) and public-sector analytics, where the stakeholder dynamics and governance demands are comparably complex.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo spec drafting and edge-case generation
 - **GitHub Copilot**, paired development and review
 - **Cursor / VSCode**, LLM-assisted prototyping
 - **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping for user-testing
 - **GPT**, stakeholder document drafting and synthesis
 - **n8n**, agentic workflow design and automation
 - **Jira + Confluence**, backlog management and programme governance
 - **Miro**, workshop facilitation and use-case mapping
-

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Helm, GitOps, Jenkins, GitLab, Docker, OpenShift, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin / Spring Boot, Kafka, Azure DevOps, MicroStrategy, Matomo, Shopware.

§ SIDE PROJECT

LIBERATION OF [BAJOR GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

A self-built multi-agent coding framework for autonomous development tasks.

- Implements a file-queue-based agent loop where specialised agents hand off work through structured artefacts.
- Architecture separates orchestration from execution, making individual agent behaviour testable in isolation.
- Active codebase maintained alongside production client work; informs how I reason about agentic AI delivery.
- Directly relevant to this role: firsthand experience with the failure modes of agentic systems sharpens use-case scoping and implementation hypothesis quality.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT REPLY DEUTSCHLAND SE

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow the existing workshops and backlog, interview the business and technical leads at the OEM, and produce a first-pass use-case map that names assumptions explicitly so nothing hides behind vague ambition.

WEEK 2

Slice and challenge.

Challenge every use case in the map against value, feasibility, and data availability, then propose a prioritised shortlist with explicit kill criteria for the ones that do not survive.

WEEK 3+

Drive and govern.

Run the recurring refinement and prioritisation cadence, maintain traceability from business goal to Jira epic to acceptance criterion, and keep the programme steering committee informed with a concise status that distinguishes delivery signal from noise.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Marcela Campos,

I am applying for the Proxy Product Owner (AI Domain Consultant) engagement at Reply Deutschland SE. With 13 years of end-to-end product ownership and the last three years spent specifically on AI and data platform programmes in regulated, engineering-heavy environments, I can step in immediately as the business-facing lead who translates AI ambitions into a delivery-ready backlog.

The role description maps closely to work I have already done. At Rohde & Schwarz I was the product manager for an internal AI and data platform supporting the FCAS European defence programme. That meant facilitating cross-functional workshops with multinational teams of architects, data scientists, and engineers, instrumenting competing workflows to surface what users actually used versus what looked good in a demo, and restructuring the delivery approach when the evidence pointed away from the original plan. At the Bundesagentur für Arbeit I owned a national labour-market analytics platform, drove the migration from bare-metal to

containerised environments, and introduced Dagster and dbt so data pipelines ran without hand-holding. Both programmes demanded the same discipline the posting describes: structuring ambiguous topics, driving decisions across business and technical teams, and keeping traceability and governance intact as the backlog evolved.

Jira and Confluence are my daily tooling. I maintain backlogs, write epics and user stories with explicit acceptance criteria, and track velocity and release readiness at the programme level. I also bring honest use-case challenge: at CLINET Platforms I cut a roadmap to its top ten percent of features and user acceptance rose fivefold. The habit of asking "what is this use case actually worth, and can we prove it before we build it?" is one I apply consistently, which is exactly what the posting means by challenging use-case value and defining pragmatic delivery slices.

I do not have direct automotive OEM experience, and I want to name that clearly rather than paper over it. What I do bring is a strong pattern match: regulated stakeholder environments with high governance demands, AI and data delivery lifecycles from ideation to MVP to industrialisation, and the ability to earn technical credibility with engineering teams quickly. The domain specifics of warranty, aftersales, or commercial systems I would learn in the first weeks; the structural and facilitation skills transfer directly.

My German is native and my English is C2 business and technical fluency. I am open to relocating to Munich and available at short notice.

I would welcome a call to discuss the programme context and how I can contribute from day one.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product manager and product owner with 13 years of end-to-end product ownership across regulated industries. The most directly relevant strand: AI and data platform delivery for Rohde & Schwarz (defence, FCAS programme) and the Bundesagentur für Arbeit (national analytics), where the work was precisely the use-case structuring, backlog governance, and cross-functional facilitation this role requires. I run continuous discovery, translate strategy and stakeholder ambition into prioritised backlogs, and keep delivery teams honest about what the evidence actually supports.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

Product Ownership: user stories, acceptance criteria, epics, backlog refinement, sprint planning, velocity and burndown, release planning, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Scrum, Kanban, SAFe, ART, PI planning, WIP limits.

Stakeholder and Leadership: stakeholder management, workshop facilitation, cross-functional team leadership, C-level reporting, conflict resolution, change management.

Analytics and Data: ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, KPI definition, MicroStrategy, Matomo.

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt engineering, evaluation loops, human-in-the-loop design, AI governance, EU AI Act, Explainable AI; prototyping with Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable.

Technical Environments Owned: Kubernetes, ArgoCD, GitOps, Docker, Jenkins, GitLab, Azure DevOps, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka.

Governance: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership.

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI / DATA PLATFORM 2024 TO 2025

Owned AI and data platform backlog for the FCAS programme; introduced GitOps with ArgoCD, cutting rollout time from days to 30 minutes; redirected product to developer-code-first design after workshop instrumentation showed zero clicks on the UI-led alternative.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC-SECTOR ANALYTICS 2023 TO 2024

National labour-market analytics platform; introduced Dagster and dbt for autonomous pipeline runs; migrated bare-metal to containers; carried full UI relaunch. Deputy IT Security Officer.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE MOBILE APP 2023

Cut an undeliverable roadmap to its top 10%; user acceptance rose fivefold. Implemented CGM hospital-system interface; reduced digital anamnesis from 30 minutes to 5.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURANCE B2B SAAS 2022

Restructured 18-person delivery org into three lean teams; attrition dropped from near-total exodus to one departure. Shipped Claims Center from concept to production.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION · RETAIL AND
PAYMENTS 2021 TO 2022

Moved research results into production in a full SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · INTERIM PRODUCT OWNER · GOVERNMENT SECURE
DATA 2021

Data structures and identity management for Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

AOK ITSCARE · PROXY PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTH INSURANCE
PROCUREMENT 2019 TO 2020

Migrated legacy system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and roughly 20,000 employees; still in production.

ENERCON · PROJECT LEAD · WIND ENERGY IT 2019

Full site IT modernisation end to end.

WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · CLINICAL NETWORK 2017
TO 2018

WLAN rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER · CONSTRUCTION
STAFFING MARKETPLACE 2025 TO 2026

Zero to one: two-sided B2B marketplace with LLM agents across the funnel, WhatsApp and Telegram as product surface.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · QUANTUM-SECURE
ENCRYPTION 2016 TO 2021

Shipped three-layer encryption product installing in under two minutes for enterprise buyers; later Chair of the board.

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES · CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO ·
NANOTECHNOLOGY / AGRITECH 2018 TO 2021

Lab to investor rounds; owned financial planning and investor reporting.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH P2P
PAYMENTS 2013 TO 2018

Built from zero to acquisition; acquired and operated by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · www.true-north.berlin · [YouTube \(EN sample\)](#)

TRUE NORTH · APPLICATION PACKAGE · FREELANCERMAP (AUFTRAGGEBER ANONYM) →